

Charlie Grussing-Neitzel

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SUMMARY

Technology leader skilled at aligning engineering strategy with business objectives to drive operational excellence, innovation, and sustainable growth. Known for building cohesive, high-performing teams where collaboration, trust, and continuous learning are core to the culture. Accomplished in transforming engineering operations to improve productivity, streamline deployment cycles, and create scalable processes that teams embrace. Recognized for a leadership style that values transparency, feedback, and work-life balance—empowering teams to deliver results with consistency, creativity, and sustained excellence.

SKILLS

- **Soft Skills:** Growth Mindset, Organized, Communication, Activator, Positivity, Fun, Devoted, Forward Thinker, CI/CD, Infrastructure as Code, Full Stack Development, React, AWS

TESTIMONIALS (from peers, direct reports, and supervisors)

- “A true curator of culture — Charlie has built processes that keep the team aligned, motivated, and delivering at a high level.”
- “The difference before Charlie and now is palpable — developers trust the process, collaborate more, and morale is higher than ever.”
- “Processes are clear, consistent, and embraced by the team — the cadence of impactful releases speaks for itself.”
- “Charlie puts the team first, valuing work-life balance, transparency, and feedback while driving delivery excellence.”
- “The maturity of our CI/CD and automation processes is remarkable for a company this size — a direct result of Charlie’s leadership.”
- “Charlie’s technical expertise, coupled with his excellent communication skills, made him an indispensable asset to our team. His ability to bridge the gap between technical complexities and team objectives was truly commendable.”
- Charlie is very thorough and detail oriented developer and leader. He brings nothing but positive energy to a team and thoughtful leadership.”

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SmartThings

Mar 2024 - Jul 2025

Manager, Engineering – Device Core

Minneapolis, MN

- Directed cross-functional initiatives by providing clear leadership and strategic collaboration, aligning engineering efforts with
- business priorities, resulting in improved project outcomes.
- Ensure React applications adhere to security standards like XSS and CSRF protection.
- Implement CI/CD pipelines and automate deployments with AWS DevOps tools.
- Owned and prioritized the Device Core (DC) Team roadmap to effectively balance engineering capacity with stakeholder business
- goals.
- Use AWS CDK or CloudFormation to automate infrastructure provisioning.
- Design event-driven architectures using Node.js with messaging queues like Kafka or RabbitMQ, & Implement GraphQL APIs and
- optimize query performance for frontend integrations.
- Provided hands-on leadership through regular 1:1s, performance reviews, and growth plans, fostering a growth mindset among
- team members.
- Lead migration of legacy frontends into modern React.js applications with optimized performance.
- Define and implement Micro Frontend Architecture for large-scale enterprise applications.
- Collaborated on initiatives to enhance the resiliency, scalability, and stability of DC services, achieving measurable
- improvements
- in reliability.
- Enhance Node.js services with caching strategies (Redis, Memcached) to improve response times & develop middleware
- solutions
- in Node.js to handle authentication, logging, and error management.
- Establish and enforce best practices in JavaScript and TypeScript coding standards.
- Design and develop scalable React.js applications with reusable components and optimized rendering.
- Implement advanced state management using Redux, Context API, or other libraries to improve application performance.
- Drive best practices for UI/UX development and ensure accessibility and responsiveness across platforms.
- Mentor teams on React design patterns and hooks to ensure maintainable codebases.
- Mentor engineers in modern JavaScript/TypeScript practices for frontend and backend development.
- Led infrastructure cost analysis and implemented cost-reduction strategies to drive operational efficiency.
- Recruited and hired top engineering talent while promoting internal high-performers, reinforcing team development and
- retention.
- Revamped team processes to focus on outcomes, including introducing Agile Scrum practices within the DC Team.
- Enhanced roadmap transparency by restructuring planning artifacts, thus improving stakeholder visibility and strategic
- alignment.

- Established team velocity tracking and forecasting to enable accurate delivery timelines and to support capacity planning.
- Cultivated a collaborative and inclusive team culture through active peer feedback, shared design ownership, and effective communication.
- Advocate for scalability, maintainability, and long-term adoption of Micro Frontend best practices.
- Co-led the restructuring of device space engineering teams in partnership with senior leadership, reinforcing alignment with business needs.
- Architect and build high-performing backend services and APIs using Node.js & Provide leadership in Node.js frameworks (Express, NestJS) for enterprise-grade applications.
- Define and implement Micro Frontend Architecture for large-scale enterprise applications & enable independent feature delivery through modular, decoupled frontend components.
- Optimize server-side applications for scalability, security, and fault tolerance & Integrate with relational and NoSQL databases while ensuring efficient data flows.
- Represented team initiatives in cross-functional discussions as a culture ambassador, contributing to company-wide strategy and engagement.
- Refined team operations and engineering standards, leading to increased productivity and technical excellence

PARKCHIRP

Chief Technology Officer

Mar 2023 - Nov 2023

Chicago, IL

- Overhauled engineering operations by instituting agile development practices, unified code flow pipelines, and streamlined Jira workflows to better align technical execution with strategic business goals.
- Lead performance tuning of Node.js applications with clustering, worker threads, and load balancing.
- Enhanced operational efficiency, with engineer's time on task increasing by 57% and production deployments advancing to multiple daily deploys.
- Lead adoption of React 18 features such as concurrent rendering and Suspense for data fetching, & integrate AI-powered UI components and personalization features using React.
- Architect event-driven systems using AWS SNS, SQS, and Event Bridge.
- Implement CI/CD automation with GitHub Actions or Code Pipeline for multi-environment deployments.
- Instituted end-to-end automated testing and integrated quality engineers into development teams, ensuring fast feedback loops and zero production reverts.
- Develop secure authentication and authorization systems using OAuth2.0, JWT, and SAML in Node.js.
- Facilitated SOC 2 compliance through vendor selection, precise requirement gathering, and project oversight, strengthening security and stakeholder confidence.
- Standardize communication and integration patterns across multiple micro frontends.
- Advocate for scalability, maintainability, and long-term adoption of Micro Frontend best practices.
- Automate testing and mocking of APIs in Node.js with frameworks like Jest, Mocha, or Super test.
- Recruited 15 engineers and reduced overall labor expenses by 43% by transitioning to an internal FTE model, supporting scalable growth.
- Translated roadmap features into clear BDD with Gherkin writeups and detailed requirements, aligning cross-functional teams on project objectives.
- Drive implementation of advanced React performance profiling to identify rendering bottlenecks.
- Optimized development workflows by creating quick scripts and aliases that decreased time managing branches and merge conflicts by 18%.
- Implement API rate limiting, throttling, and caching in Node.js for high-traffic applications.
- Mentored technical staff on development practices while cultivating clear growth paths and aligning team efforts with evolving business priorities.
- Integrate GraphQL clients (Apollo/Relay) into React applications for optimized data fetching.
- Collaborated with executive leadership to address team wellbeing, reduce burnout, and ensure strategic prioritization of milestones.
- Contributed to high-priority full-stack features, balancing rapid delivery with maintaining technical excellence, which enhanced product quality and delivery speed

PARKCHIRP

Principal Software Engineer

Sep 2022 - Mar 2023

Chicago, IL

- Contributed as a full stack engineer to a microservice SaaS platform using React, GraphQL, Node.js, and MySQL in AWS Cloud Services (Lambda, Cognito, EC2, DynamoDB, etc.), ensuring technical excellence and reliability.
- Built and delivered technically complex serverless services, reinforcing cross-team integration and operational efficiency.
- Led the full rebuild of the platform stack with React 18, Next.js, and a revamped API v2 using GraphQL, ensuring alignment with current technical best practices.
- Introduced robust coding standards and streamlined project repository taxonomy to promote maintainability and clarity across development teams.

EXOSITE

Director of Software Delivery

Sep 2018 - Jul 2022

Minneapolis, MN

- Identified and rectified inefficiencies in Jenkins build and delivery pipelines, reducing average deployment time from 1.5 hours to under minutes and boosting team velocity by 34% year over year.
- Enhanced infrastructure monitoring and reduced monthly cloud expenses from over \$200k to under \$50k without impacting end user experience or platform performance.
- Addressed performance bottlenecks by spearheading performance and scalability testing, streamlining data flow and API interactions across services.
- Oversaw and collaborate daily with multicultural engineering teams (Devs, DevOps, QA) across US, Czech, Hungary, Taiwan, and Brazil, fostering a culture of clear communication and strategic mentorship.
- Conducted regular 1-on-1 mentoring, annual 360° reviews, and skill development support for individual contributors and emerging leaders, driving team growth.
- Boosted team morale and ensured zero attrition over 3.5 years by organizing innovative initiatives like hackathons, bug squashing events, and social hours, resulting in an engaged and productive team.
- Managed a partial company sell-off by reducing the workforce by 67% while maintaining 99.9% platform uptime and consistent delivery of client features.

Exosite

Senior Front End Developer, Tech Lead

Feb 2017 – Sep 2018

- Was the go-to developer for high profile front-end feature delivery, optimizations and enhancements
- Maintained relationships with product owners and UI/UX designers to build out Exosite's Industrial IoT Platform (Murano) and flagship Remote Condition Monitoring (RCM) SaaS product, ExoSense
- Worked in front end development: HTML, CSS SASS, JavaScript–React Redux Redux-sagas, REST APIs, Node.js
- Enforced coding best practices and DRY code implementation through pair programming and code reviews
- Coordinated with Taiwan team members for task completion, coding consistency and solution architecting
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- Skills: Web Applications · Front End Developers · Apollo GraphQL · JavaScript · Front-end · Intercultural Communication · Full Stack Development · User Experience · Team Leadership · Back-end Operations · Website Development · Enterprise Architecture · User Interface Design · User Interface

TIES

Senior Lead Software Developer – edSpring

Oct 2013 – Jan 2017

- UI/UX Design (Wireframes, High-fidelity mockups, Workflows, etc.)
- Full Stack development (React, NodeJS, MeteorJS)
- Database scripting and architecture (MongoDB)
- Direct client collaboration
- Project management, road mapping, chartering, storyboarding, estimating
- Facilitated Agile development methodologies
- Managing app deployments to server environments
- Section 508 and WCAG 2.0 subject matter expert advisor
- Team building and mentoring
- Greenfield App Highlight: ed Spring Monitor – Solo developer responsible for designing and developing a RTI Reading assessment Mobile First Web application to give and assess students reading fluency, accuracy and vocabulary with real-time assessment score measuring and touch-screen interface reading passage tracking
- Greenfield App Highlight: Spring Math (www.springmath.org) — Lead Developer charged to implement researched based progression algorithm for grades 1–6 Math assessments using modern, real-time reactive Web application (SPA). Has since won multiple EdTech awards
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Merrill Corporation

Jan 2010 – Oct 2013

Web Developer

- Maintained Company website using OpenText CMS
- Maintained and extend functionality of company SharePoint sites
- Maintain Merrill's marketing web sites
- Create mock-ups and design proposals for new feature requests
- Implement new feature requests and provide QA
- Work with clients to facilitate the custom needs for web request forms
- Manage a team of offshore resources for work pertaining to custom web form product
- Prioritized, scoped, articulated deliverables for new client scheduling forms
- Administrator and SharePoint Developer for Merrill's Legal Services SharePoint environment
- Maintained Company website using OpenText CMS
- Maintained and extend functionality of company SharePoint sites
- Maintain Merrill's marketing web sites
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- Work with clients to facilitate the custom needs for web request forms
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- Prioritized, scoped, articulated deliverables for new client scheduling forms
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Skills: Front End Developers · React · Mobile Applications · JavaScript · Front-end · SEO · User Experience · Team Leadership · Website Development · User Interface Design · User Interface · Node

Analysts International Corporation (AIC)

Mar 2009 – Nov 2010

Web Application Developer

- Convert Business Requirements documents into Visio wireframes and work flows
- Build design documents and style guides for developers
- Create high fidelity storyboards detailing the actual user interface of the application.
- SQL Server Reporting Services
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- Build design documents and style guides for developers
- Create high fidelity storyboards detailing the actual user interface of the application.
- SQL Server Reporting Services

Skills: Front-end · Consulting · User Experience · Website Development · User Interface Design · User Interface

Inetium

May 2008 – Feb 2009

SharePoint Designer, UI Developer

- Complete overhauling Microsoft Sharepoint environments to look like front-end marketing sites
- Build mock-ups and provide design direction for Web Application and Sharepoint projects
- Meet with clients to understand business requirements and goals
- Assist with presenting and implementing solutions to fit client needs.
- Manage multiple accounts and priorities at once
- Tightly track billing and project budgets for client projects
- Served as a Search Engine Optimization (SEO) specialist.
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Skills: Front-end · Consulting · User Experience · User Interface Design · User Interface

University of Minnesota - Center for Transportation Studies

Dec 2005 – May 2008

Web Coordinator

- Coordinated the development and maintenance of 13 mid- to large-scale program websites
- Re-designing websites
- Developing processes to improve communication and efficiency with CTS's web presence
- Search Engine Optimization and Google Analytics
- Section 508 & WCAG 2.0 Implementation
- Supervisor and mentor to student Web interns.
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- Re-designing websites
- Developing processes to improve communication and efficiency with CTS's web presence
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- Supervisor and mentor to student Web interns.

Skills: Front-end · SEO · User Experience · User Interface Design · User Interface

Osseo Area Schools

Aug 2001 – Dec 2005

District Webmaster

- Curriculum Specialist for Web development practices and software
- Web Standards and Best Practices for the Minnesota Technology Implementation Plan for Osseo
- System Administrator for Blackboard™ Online Learning
- Managing District Website
- Managing, supporting, and mentoring 30 School building Site Webmasters
- Instruction in Web development, graphic design, and digital video editing
- Department Chairperson
- School Site Webmaster including website redesign
- Curriculum Specialist for Web development practices and software
- Web Standards and Best Practices for the Minnesota Technology Implementation Plan for Osseo
- System Administrator for Blackboard™ Online Learning
- Managing District Website
- Managing, supporting, and mentoring 30 School building Site Webmasters

Skills: SEO · User Experience · User Interface Design · User Interface

EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin-Stout

Bachelor's Degree, Technology Education w/ emphasis in Telecommunications